VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF TUE OCT 13 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

FAA opens a full environmental review of 456 Starship launches a year from Starbase

The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) published a notice today that it will prepare a programmatic environmental impact statement on SpaceX's plan to raise Starship operations at Starbase, Texas, to as many as 456 launches and 912 landings a year, from 25 launches today. Public scoping meetings are set for November 17 to 19, with comments due November 30. SPCX fell 4.21% to $156.54 on Tuesday, the day the plan became public.

Ship 40, the first Starship to come back to its launch site after flying, now stands in a Megabay, where SpaceX says it will yield "first-of-its-kind data" on a flown heatshield. Cargo Dragon is due at the space station Thursday, the same evening a Falcon 9 is scheduled to launch USSF-481. SpaceXAI agreed to testify before the New York City Council on Friday. There were no new SEC filings.

I · STARSHIP & LAUNCHES

Ship 40 goes vertical for a teardown of a flown heatshield

No SpaceX launches since CRS-35 on Tuesday morning; the returned Starship is now indoors at Starbase.



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

Ship 40 in the Megabay

"The first Starship to return to its launch site, Ship 40's journey took it across air, space, and sea," SpaceX posted at 5:52 p.m. EDT Tuesday. "Now that it is vertical alongside three other Starships in a Megabay at Starbase, it will provide first-of-its-kind data on a flown Starship heatshield, Raptor engines, avionics, and more." Ship 40 made the program's first intact ocean splashdown on Flight 13 in July and kept floating; crews towed it to Christmas Island after 24 days adrift, took heatshield samples there and shipped it to Texas, TeslaNorth reported. Musk shared the return as well.

CRS-35 en route

Cargo Dragon, launched at 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday with the station's last pair of roll-out solar arrays, is set to dock autonomously on Thursday at about 11 a.m. EDT, SpaceX said. Its booster landed at Landing Zone 40. Falcon 9 has flown more than 110 times this year and is on pace for about 150 launches, against 165 in 2025, Invezz reported.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

USSF-481 Thursday night; a second Starlink is added for next week

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT); date changes are noted in the mission column.

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Thu Oct 15, 7:44 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481, US Space Force; booster B1081, 28th flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2 (listed "Go")
Mon Oct 19, 6:30 a.m.	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 mid-inclination rideshare	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Tue Oct 20, 6:14 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15	Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16. **New** on the schedule	Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET November	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Sun Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; Musk says a ship catch will be attempted	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16 (Starlink Group 30-1), likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. Sources: Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs), whose times are unofficial; NASASpaceflight, citing range-planning (CADENA) slides. No dates slipped since Tuesday's issue. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

III · STARLINK

Top marks in rural Britain



A faint string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky above the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.
PHOTO: DKTUE · WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0

"Try @Starlink Internet!" Musk wrote on Tuesday, quoting a post saying Starlink ranked first for both download speed and consistent quality among rural users in the UK in a study by network analytics firm Opensignal, ahead of EE, Three and Vodafone. According to that post, Starlink also led rural download speeds in all 14 European markets studied. The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) approval of SpaceX's 15,000-satellite direct-to-device system still carries a surety-bond deadline of November 4 (Section V).

IV · AI & COMPUTE

SpaceXAI will testify in New York on Friday

SpaceXAI agreed to appear before the New York City Council's Committee on Technology on Friday, October 16, at 10 a.m. EDT, ending a standoff that began with a September 28 subpoena, amNY reported. The company skipped the council's October 5 hearing, where OpenAI, Anthropic, Google and Meta testified under oath; the council then said it would ask a state judge to enforce the subpoena. The council has not said who SpaceXAI will send. "Conspicuously absent was SpaceXAI, which is unacceptable," Speaker Julie Menin said in a statement on Tuesday.

On X, Musk spent much of Tuesday promoting Grok Bot features, including LEGO sets he said Grok Bot had bought. Replying to a post on a Morgan Stanley note about SpaceX as a distributed inference cloud, he wrote: "True, this is a very big deal."

FAA starts the Starbase review

A notice of intent in today's Federal Register opens scoping on up to 456 Starship launches a year; nothing new at the SEC.

FAA

Notice of intent · Oct 14 — The FAA will prepare a Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement (PEIS) on SpaceX's proposal to increase Starship-Super Heavy operations at the Boca Chica launch site at Starbase and to add Starship landing and expenditure locations (docket FAA-2026-12808; 91 FR 65289). Later license changes and temporary airspace closures fall within its scope. Federal Register

What is proposed — Phase 1 allows up to 100 launches and 200 landings a year, at any time on any day; Phase 2, expected within several years, raises the cap to 456 launches and 912 landings, with launches on weekdays only, Invezz reported. The current limit is 25 launches and 50 landings. Four in-person scoping meetings are set for November 17 and 19 and a virtual one for November 18; comments are due November 30, SpacePolicyOnline reported.

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — Scoping comments on Starship at Space Launch Complex 37, Cape Canaveral (up to 76 launches a year), closed today (docket FAA-2026-10792). Federal Register

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Tuesday and 8:30 a.m. EDT Wednesday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities; 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FCC

Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain

Oct 6 · Gen2 direct-to-device order — 15,000 satellites granted in part; surety bond due November 4. Exterra

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Takeaways

1. The FAA opened a full environmental review of up to 456 Starship launches a year at Starbase; comments are due November 30.
2. SPCX fell 4.21% to $156.54 as the plan became public.
3. Ship 40 is upright in a Megabay for heatshield and engine data.
4. Dragon docks Thursday about 11 a.m. EDT; USSF-481 launches Thursday 7:44 p.m. EDT.
5. SpaceXAI testifies to the New York City Council Friday at 10 a.m. EDT.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceX and @elonmusk on X; Federal Register; TeslaNorth, Invezz, SpacePolicyOnline, amNY, New York City Council, NASASpaceflight, Launch Library 2, Grain Management, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Steve Jurvetson via Wikimedia Commons (CC BY 2.0); Dktue via Wikimedia Commons (CC0).

The SpaceX Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Space Exploration Technologies Corp., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

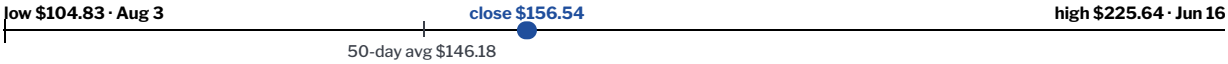
Down 4% as the Starbase review is announced

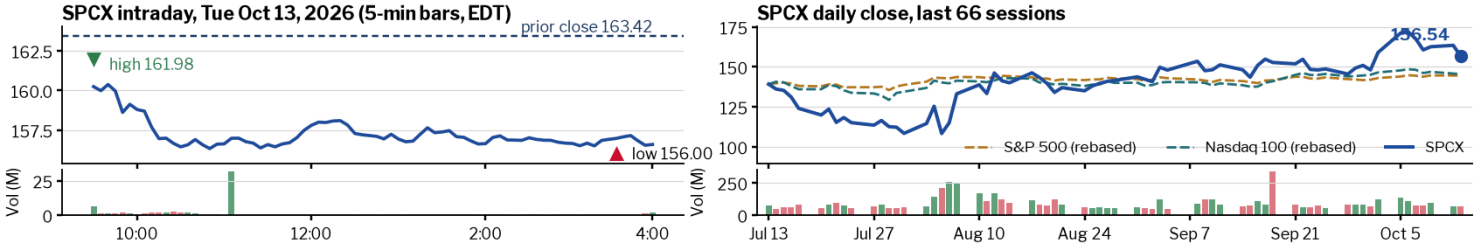
Shares opened at the day's high and slid to $156.05 by mid-afternoon, falling 4.21% as regulators set an environmental review of Starbase expansion; the Nasdaq 100 slipped 0.31%.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$156.54	−$6.88	$161.98	$161.98	$156.05
Tue Oct 13, 4:00 p.m. EDT	−4.21% vs $163.42	regular session	9:30 a.m. EDT bar	3:30 p.m. EDT bar

VOLUME	RANGE SINCE IPO	MARKET CAP	5-DAY / 1-MONTH	SINCE LISTING
68.72M	$105–$226	$2.06T	−8.95% / +5.66%	+16.0%
−24.3% vs 30-session avg 90.82M	no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)	13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.12T with Cursor shares	5 and 21 sessions	vs $135 IPO price; −2.74% vs first close

SINCE IPO, OCT 13





As of close Oct 13, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 13 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−4.21%**	**−8.95%**	**+5.66%**	**−2.74%**
S&P 500	−0.02%	−0.17%	+2.43%	+5.03%
Nasdaq 100	−0.31%	−2.10%	+4.95%	+3.15%
RKLB	−2.27%	−14.44%	+2.67%	−37.28%
ASTS	−8.54%	−25.44%	−21.56%	−42.89%
IRDM	−0.72%	−4.71%	+1.19%	−1.25%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, RETRIEVED WED OCT 14, 8:24 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 14	60,595	28,182	0.47	52.6%	$160 / $155
Oct 16	409,344	414,561	1.01	50.4%	$165 / $100
Oct 19	26,339	9,215	0.35	41.4%	$170 / $162.50
All expiries	**2,328,658**	**2,379,647**	**1.02**		**30-day IV index 51.6**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 14

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (31 analysts)	$221.26 (+41.3%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.49%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 13 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.99)	78.7
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	89.5
Beta	—
50-day average	$146.18 (+7.1%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (16 analysts)	$0.17
Q3 revenue est. (17)	$12.98B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Sat Oct 24	**Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more**
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns, averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 13). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Wed Oct 14, 8:24 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Tuesday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $157.50 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.22T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); 1.3B more shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. FCC dates: Exterra.